

available as a freeware in the most essential components and garnered its fair share of admirers across the world.

History and development

WPS Office was simply an acronym for Writer-Presentation-Spreadsheet when it was marketed in 2001 as a commercial enterprise grade office suite. However, in its original design as a word processing system it was known as 'WPS under DOS' during the late 1980s in Hong Kong when it was being developed for Chinese automation companies. Due to the monopolistic nature of Chinese markets and lack of competition from the rest of the world, WPS Office evolved from the immense success of the DOS-based WPS. This was prior to the operating system boom of Windows in the mid-1990s with its Windows 95 and Word 95 applications.

The change in the global office suite competition caused by Microsoft pushed Kingsoft towards new innovations and development was accelerated to meet the challenge. Within a year, WPS 97 for Windows was available for release, followed in time by the WPS 2000 edition. Both of these systems were fairly successful within the local markets in the face of Microsoft's own Word and Office suites. With this victory, Kingsoft achieved full development of the other complementary applications for spreadsheets and presentations and launched WPS Office as an office suite.

Kingsoft's next boost came in 2001 when it bundled an email client into its office suite and released the widely acclaimed WPS Office 2002. With each successive iteration, the office suite achieved closer familiarity to the predominance of Windows' office suite and improved user migration since retraining requirement was minimised. Kingsoft enjoyed its biggest success when the Chinese government made the WPS Office suite its preferred standard for office use.

Working with Kingsoft Office

One of the biggest surprises of working on the Kingsoft Office suite is the similarity in experience to the Windows experience, especially Office 2013. The user friendly layout and design almost makes the applications appear to be slight modifications of the all too familiar Office 2013 design. Even the freeware version performs beyond expectations across all the applications from word processing to presentation design.

The newest version of the software allows for the tabbing of multiple documents, presentations or spreadsheet files for quick switching. The small